

Tanks of the NATO Alliance

Without an equivalent to Soviet domination, NATO nations were free to produce a wide range of tanks. All were intended to defend Western Europe against a Soviet threat, but differing national doctrines led to a variety of different designs. The German Leopards, for example, emphasized mobility and had very light armor, whereas the British Chieftain was far more heavily armored but much less mobile. Many of these tanks were exported to other NATO members and Western allies across the world.



△ **M41A1 Walker Bulldog**

Date	1951	Country	USA
Weight	25.5 tons (23.2 tonnes)		
Engine	Continental AOS-895-3 gasoline, 500 hp		
Main armament	76 mm M32 L/64 gun		

The replacement for the M24 Chaffee, the M41 was designed to have significantly heavier firepower, but still be light enough to be transported by air. It was widely exported around the world and saw combat with the Americans and the South Vietnamese. A number of nations still use it.

▽ **M47 Patton**

Date	1952	Country	USA
Weight	48 tons (43.6 tonnes)		
Engine	Continental AV1790-5A gasoline, 810 hp		
Main armament	90 mm M36 L/50 rifled gun		

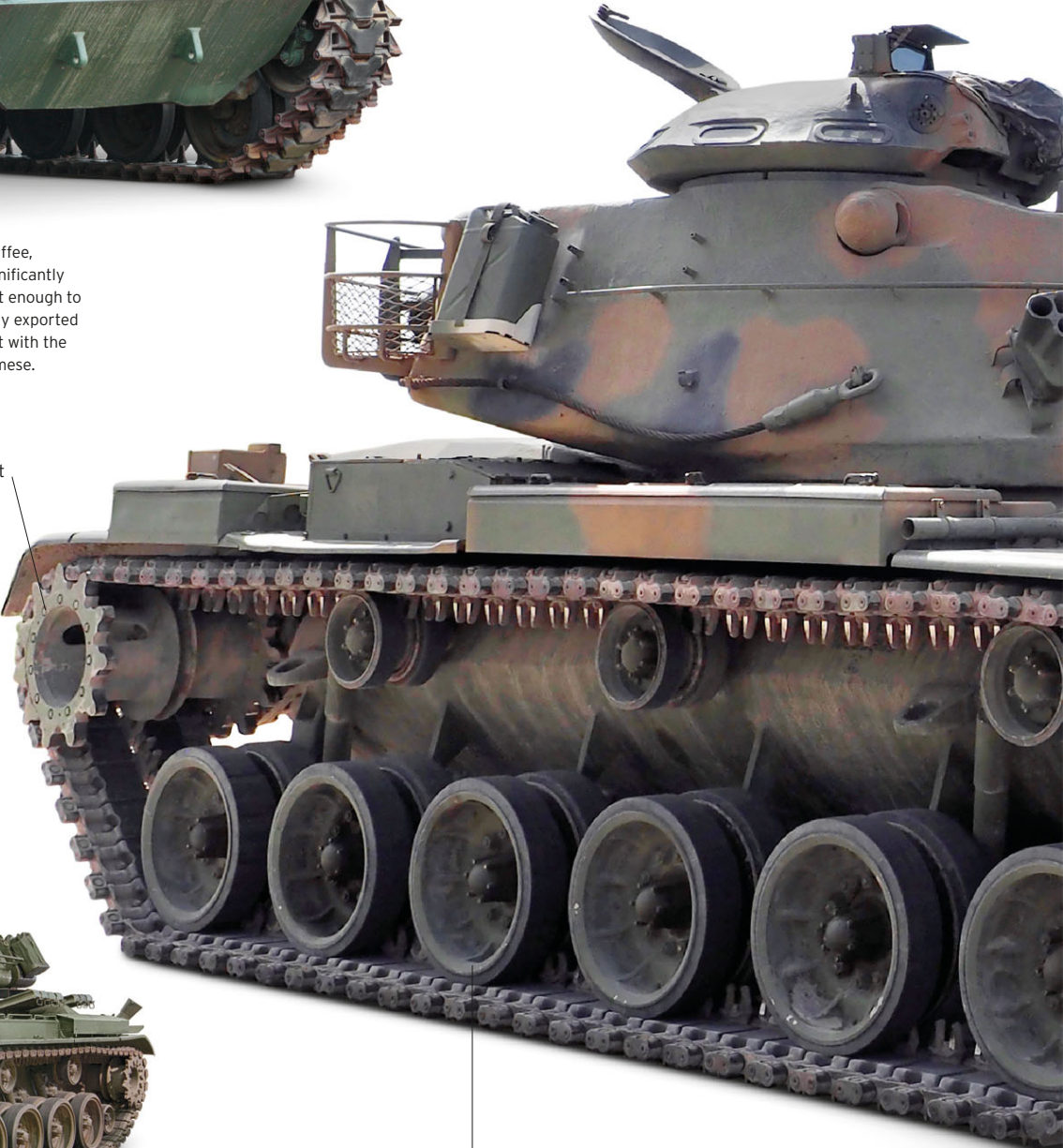
The M47 was an interim vehicle using the hull of the M46 and a new turret. Although the Americans had replaced it with the M48 by the end of the 1950s, more than 9,000 M47s were built. It was widely exported to American allies under the Military Assistance Program. Many of these countries operated it for decades and several used it in combat.



△ **Centurion Mark I**

Date	1945	Country	UK
Weight	51 tons (46.2 tonnes)		
Engine	Rolls-Royce Meteor Mark IVA gasoline, 640 hp		
Main armament	Ordnance QF 17-pounder gun		

The design of the Centurion began in 1943. It used the engine and transmission of the Comet, in a vehicle large enough to take the 17-pounder gun. Six prototypes were sent to Europe just weeks after the end of the war in 1945. The Mark I, which entered service in 1946, had a 20 mm Polsten cannon in a separate mount.



Road wheels